

Daily Market Summary

August 04, 2026

No US trading session on 2026-08-05. Figures are from the last session (2026-08-04).

Market Tone — Today's Session

A recap of how the market traded today — not a forecast.

Today: +0.27 → Slightly Bullish

Trend (5-day EMA): +0.17 → Slightly Bullish — smoothed, the readable day-over-day signal.

Component	Weight	Score
Market data	70%	+0.45
News headlines	20%	-0.13
Fed (rate expectations)	10%	-0.20

Equities rose with Nasdaq +3.3%, S&P 500 +1.8%, VIX +4.0%. Sector breadth: 7/11 sectors up. 10Y yield -1.3%. News headlines read slightly bearish. Fed-policy expectations tightened (13-Week T-Bill Yield +3.0bp). Today's overall market tone: Slightly Bullish. (news scored with finbert)

Standout headlines

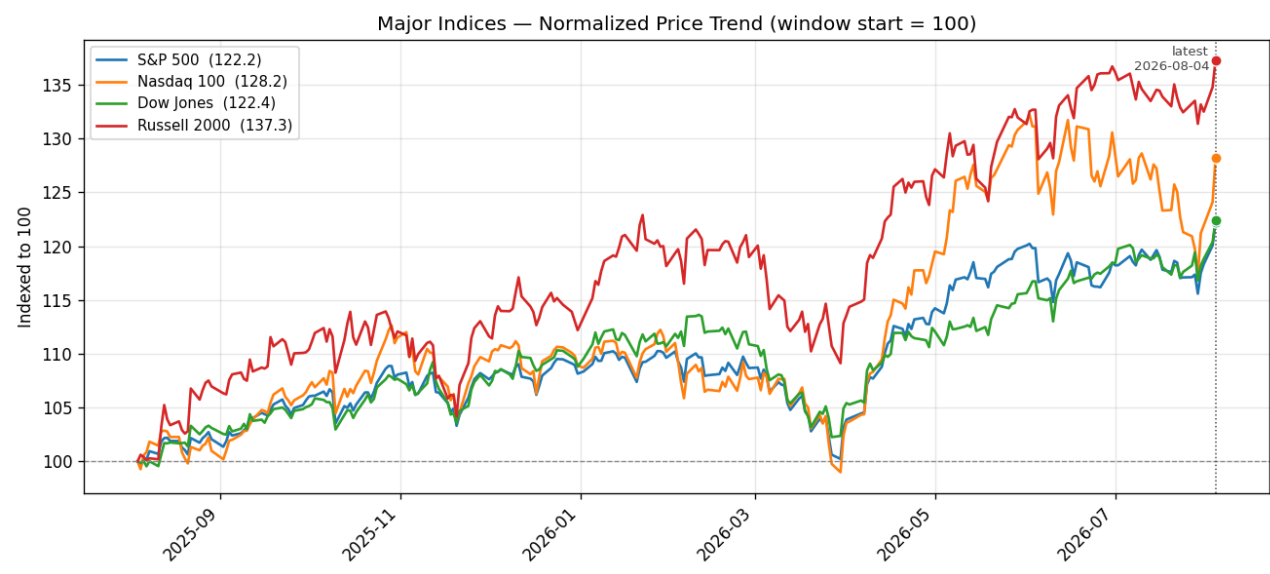
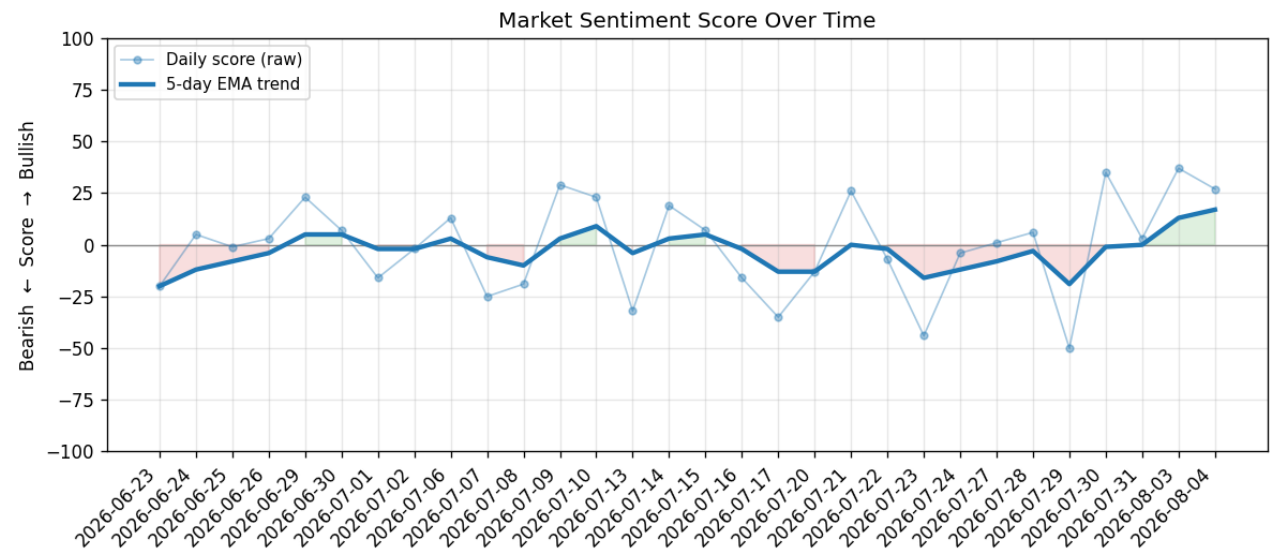
Most bullish (+0.32) — Stocks making the biggest moves after the bell: SpaceX, AMD, Pinterest, Arista Networks, Wynn Resorts & more

Most bearish (-0.92) — AMD shares slide after SpaceX commits to rival Nvidia; What are the implications?

Divergence Alert

■■ Divergence: prices rose but the news mood is negative — the tape is climbing a wall of worry.

Trend Charts



Sector Watch (AI Stack)

Score describes the day: driven by the session move (70%), with breadth (avg % of the 20/50-day MAs the basket trades above, 15%) and news (15%) for texture. Relative strength (vs the Nasdaq for tech baskets, the S&P for the rest) is shown as a context column but doesn't drive the label. Sorted strongest→weakest.

Sector	Move	Rel. Str.	Breadth	News	Overall
SaaS	+3.74%	+0.42% vs Nasdaq	100%	Neutral	Bullish (+0.91)
Networking / Interconnect	+6.61%	+3.29% vs Nasdaq	79%	Slightly Bullish	Bullish (+0.87)
Semiconductors / Compute	+7.16%	+3.84% vs Nasdaq	65%	Neutral	Bullish (+0.83)
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	+5.83%	+2.51% vs Nasdaq	25%	Slightly Bullish	Bullish (+0.75)
Banking	+1.17%	-0.62% vs S&P	94%	Neutral	Bullish (+0.61)
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	+1.11%	-2.21% vs Nasdaq	71%	Neutral	Bullish (+0.54)
Consumer	+0.96%	-0.83% vs S&P	56%	Neutral	Bullish (+0.45)
Pharma / Healthcare	+0.19%	-1.60% vs S&P	62%	Neutral	Slightly Bullish (+0.22)

Positioning & Regime

Was today bullish or bearish, read through positioning: out-of-the-money put/call volume (hedging vs chasing, daily) and short %-of-float (squeeze fuel; exchange data, biweekly) explain the character of the day's move — squeeze rebound, hedged advance, conviction selling. **Under evaluation** — logged daily, drives no scores.

Basket	OTM P/C	Short Flt	Day	Today's Read
SaaS	1.11	5.4%	+3.74%	Bullish — advance, but heavily hedged — protection still bid
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	0.97	5.7%	+5.83%	Bullish — short-squeeze rebound — shorts/puts were loaded into the selloff and fueled the rip
Pharma / Healthcare	0.82	1.8%	+0.19%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Banking	0.76	0.0%	+1.17%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Networking / Interconnect	0.76	4.3%	+6.61%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Consumer	0.74	2.0%	+0.97%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable

Semiconductors / Compute	0.73	2.4%	+7.16%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	0.68	1.7%	+1.11%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
All tracked	0.80	2.4%	+2.72%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable

Bloomberg News Summary

The Close

Breaking Down SpaceX's First Earnings Report | The Close 8/4/2026 (aired 2026-08-04) · Full-transcript summary · [watch on YouTube](#)

Key takeaways

- **S&P 500 hits 26th record high of 2026** on a four-day rally (strongest since April 2025), driven by falling oil prices and yields. Market breadth improved significantly—337 names contributed to the rally since June lows, despite weakness in Tesla, Micron, Oracle, and Nvidia.
- **Europe outpaces US** with record highs across Stoxx 600, DAX, and CAC 40, powered by exceptional earnings (17% growth consensus vs. typical 0-1%) and strong analyst upgrades across nearly every sector including luxury.
- **SpaceX's first earnings as public company:** Q2 revenue of \$7.8B beat estimates (\$6.81B expected), but shares fell ~7% after-hours. Starlink hit 12M subscribers (only profitable segment). AI segment lost \$1.26B (better than \$2.39B expected). \$18B CapEx raised questions; announced Nvidia partnership for orbital data centers launching 2027.
- **McDonald's slowing:** US comp sales growth just 0.8% (1.3% overall)—slowest since early 2025. July turned negative. Attributed to value perception issues and inconsistent franchisee execution on sub-\$3 menu; third of franchisees didn't participate.

Guest views

- **Ananya Lodi, Invesco:** AI trade has legs globally; hyperscale CapEx will continue despite Fed rate moves; market focused on micro (AI bottlenecks, free cash flow) over macro currently.
- **Richelieu Dennis, Sundial Group:** Essence Ventures' investment in Revolt/Off Script targets multi-generational cultural brands with 50-year horizons; combining male-focused Revolt with female-focused Essence creates complete youth culture ecosystem.
- **Nick Setyan, Mizuho:** McDonald's has a value perception problem, not a strategy problem; casual dining winning traffic as McDonald's takes 3-5% pricing while competitors restrain increases.
- **Nate Baxter, Scotts Miracle-Gro:** Conservative 5-8% EPS growth target through 2029 based on 10% household penetration opportunity, channel expansion (e-commerce now 13% vs. 5% pre-pandemic), and pivot to digital advertising.
- **Ross Gerber, Gerber Kawasaki:** SpaceX's Nvidia partnership and rapid orbital data center development is "high risk, high reward"; Starlink "just beginning" with massive military applications and backup internet market; concerned about XAI integration but optimistic long-term.
- **Sinead O'Sullivan, Harvard:** Starship faces "engineering slippage" due to complexity far beyond Falcon rockets; questions whether demand justifies aggressive launch cadence since lower launch costs haven't spurred expected demand growth.

Stocks & sectors discussed

McDonald's (weak US comps), Scotts Miracle-Gro (Investor Day growth targets), SpaceX (first earnings post-IPO), AMD (beat but fell 7% after-hours on margin concerns), optical equipment makers (Corning, Marvell, Coherent rallied on potential China component ban), Generac (AI data center power demand), Nike (downgraded to underweight), Palantir (upgraded, +30%), European equities (Stoxx 600 records).

Most striking quote

"If you can see returns on invested capital for the hyperscalers on that investment, the markets are supportive. They will continue to probably invest... It's the AI minutiae of hyperscale CapEx, bottleneck spend, etc. that is more preoccupying equity investors right now than interest rates." —
Ananya Lodi, Invesco

Top Gainers

Company	Price	% Change
Wayfair Inc. (W)	116.08	+29.97%
Palantir Technologies Inc. (PLTR)	162.66	+29.45%
Paymentus Holdings, Inc. (PAY)	44.60	+29.20%
Zebra Technologies Corporation (ZBRA)	368.83	+26.47%
UFP Technologies, Inc. (UFPT)	334.84	+25.16%

Top News

If you invested \$1,000 in gold, Bitcoin and \$TRUMP on Inauguration Day, here is what each is worth today — Yahoo Finance

So what’s the plan to bring down inflation? The new Fed chair and his White House allies say you shouldn’t ask. — MarketWatch (Top)

Critics say Kevin Warsh’s determination to cool prices gains isn’t sufficient.

Stocks making the biggest moves after the bell: SpaceX, AMD, Pinterest, Arista Networks, Wynn Resorts & more — CNBC (Finance)

These are the stocks posting the largest moves after the bell.

Why is NVIDIA stock rising afterhours? — Investing.com

Philadelphia Fed President Paulson content with rates at current level, but keeping an open mind — CNBC (Finance)

Paulson said voting with the majority last week wasn't a tough decision.

Market Snapshot

Major Indices

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
S&P 500	7,736.52	+136.02	+1.79%
Nasdaq 100	29,733.16	+956.36	+3.32%
Dow Jones	54,085.88	+907.47	+1.71%
Russell 2000	3,036.98	+55.07	+1.85%
VIX	16.50	+0.64	+4.04%

Key Stocks

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Nvidia	211.94	+5.30	+2.56%
Microsoft	492.81	+5.16	+1.06%
AMD	518.58	+33.94	+7.00%
Meta	587.94	-2.30	-0.39%
Alphabet	375.35	+2.88	+0.77%
Broadcom	418.16	+25.93	+6.61%
Micron	892.67	+63.17	+7.62%
Intel	100.86	+9.86	+10.84%
SanDisk	1,427.62	+139.59	+10.84%
Coherent	323.73	+35.59	+12.35%
Amazon	277.42	-6.60	-2.32%
Apple	309.38	+5.96	+1.96%
Arm	280.56	+41.50	+17.36%

Commodities & Crypto

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Gold	4,137.90	-14.70	-0.35%
Crude Oil	75.43	-0.34	-0.45%
Bitcoin	63,929.21	+146.91	+0.23%

FX Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
EUR/USD	1.15	+0.00	+0.00%
USD/JPY	157.58	-0.20	-0.13%
GBP/USD	1.35	-0.00	-0.01%

Interest Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
10Y Treasury Yield	4.63	-0.06	-1.26%
13-Week T-Bill Yield	3.73	+0.03	+0.81%

Analyst Summary

Broad Rally Led by Semiconductors

U.S. equities posted strong gains on August 5, 2026, with the Nasdaq 100 surging +3.32% to lead major benchmarks. The S&P 500 rose +1.79% to 7,736.52, while the Dow Jones added +1.71%. The Russell 2000 climbed +1.85%, reflecting broad participation across market caps. The rally extended the market's recent momentum, building on a four-day winning streak that represents the strongest stretch since April 2025.

Semiconductor and AI Infrastructure Surge

Semiconductor and AI-related stocks dominated the session, with several standout performers. **Arm Holdings** rocketed +17.36%, while **Coherent** surged +12.35% and **Intel** and **SanDisk** each jumped +10.84%. **Micron** advanced +7.62%, **AMD** gained +7.00%, and **Broadcom** added +6.61%. Nvidia climbed +2.56%, recovering after-hours following news of a partnership with SpaceX for orbital data centers launching in 2027.

The AI Stack sector performance underscores the breadth of the rally: Semiconductors/Compute rose +7.16%, Networking/Interconnect +6.61%, Memory +5.83%, and SaaS +3.74%—all significantly outpacing the broader Nasdaq. Positioning data suggests the Memory sector's rally was fueled in part by a short squeeze, with elevated short interest and put activity unwinding into strength.

Market-Wide Gainers Reflect Risk Appetite

Beyond semiconductors, the day's top gainers spanned diverse sectors. **Wayfair** soared +29.97%, **Palantir Technologies** jumped +29.45% following an analyst upgrade, **Paymentus Holdings** rose +29.20%, and **Zebra Technologies** climbed +26.47%. This broad participation signals robust risk appetite, despite notable weakness in **Amazon** (-2.32%) following news that Jeff Bezos filed to sell \$4 billion in shares.

Rates, Yields, and Cross-Asset Signals

Treasury yields declined, with the 10-year falling 6 basis points to 4.63%, suggesting continued expectations for eventual Fed easing despite Philadelphia Fed President Paulson's comments that he is "content with rates at current level." The VIX edged up +4.04% to 16.50, a modest rise that appears disconnected from the day's equity strength and may reflect residual hedging demand. Gold slipped -0.35% and crude oil declined -0.45%, while Bitcoin gained +0.23%.

Currency markets were quiet, with EUR/USD flat at 1.15 and USD/JPY down slightly to 157.58, consistent with the modest decline in U.S. yields.

The combination of falling yields, surging tech stocks, and broad market participation suggests investors are looking past near-term Fed policy uncertainty and focusing on robust AI infrastructure demand and strong earnings fundamentals.